MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION OCTOBER 2025

THIRD SEMESTER - DISCIPLINE SPECIFIC CORE COURSE (DSC) –

MG3DSCHIS202 - ORIGINS OF THE MODERN WORLD

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 Hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Part A SHORT ANSWER

Answer any 10 questions Each question carries 2 marks

1.What is meant by subsistence-based economy? [U] / [CO1] – characteristic feature of Feudal economy – production for self-consumption and not for production for exchange – commodity production primarily not market oriented.

2. Define journeymen. [K] / [CO1] – part of medieval European production system – though fully trained in craft since they lacked means to setup own workshop or business remined as hired worker for the master craftsmen in guild system – formed separate guilds later – journeymen associations later evolved as trade unions.

3. What is meant by the 'prime mover' in the transition debate? [U] / [CO2] – Prime mover is the key factor for change that is the primary cause for the decline of feudalism and emergence of capitalism – debate revolved around locating the prime mover (cause) within or outside the feudal relations of production

4. What is meant by Meiji Restoration? [U] / [CO2] – Reassertion of the Japanese imperial control over administrative apparatus- Japan remained under the control of feudal landlords between 12th to 19th century – in 1868 ousting the Shogun lords control Emperor reorganized administration around the throne.

5. Savonorola of Florence. [K] / [CO3] – Dominican friar active in Renaissance Florance – Critical of the secular art and culture – Calls for Christian renewal of Florance – Instituted extreme moralistic campaign

6. Recall the significance of the Renaissance artpiece 'Statue of David'. [U] / [CO3] – masterpiece sculpture by Michelangelo – first colossal marble statue of High Renaissance – represented the corporality of the Florentine body politic – exaltation of human over metaphysical representations

7. What is meant by scholasticism? [U] / [CO3] – Medieval European philosophical system exerted considerable influence on higher learning, especially in the universities – influence of Aristotelian logic – reconciliation between classical philosophy and western Christianity

8. Recall the theme of Descartes's 'What can be called into doubt'? [K] / [CO4] - Descartes argued that everything, including beliefs derived from the senses, dreams, and even mathematical truths, can be called into doubt - methodical doubt – questioning to find a foundation of absolute certainty.

9. Utopian Socialism. [U] / [CO4] – one of the early form of modern socialist thought – advocated the creation of a ideal, communal living and labour organization through peaceful means – Argued for community sense instead of individualism – imaginative than pragmatic in thought.

10. What is called the 'dual nature of light'? [K] / [CO4] – debate on the nature of light among natural philosophers – Newton's argument in favour of particle nature and Christiaan Huygens argument in favour of wave nature of light – both are correct, since light possessed these two natures.

11. What is meant by 'world empires' in the World Systems Theory? [K] / [CO5] - one among the three social systems as per Wallenstein - 'World empires is a large, single centred political structure - characterized by extraction of tribute by a central authority.

12. Ferdinand Magellan. [K] / [CO5] – Portuguese explorer – planned and led the Spanish expedition to the East Indies – First European crossed the Pacific Ocean – killed in a battle in the present day Philippines/

Part B SHORT ESSAY

Answer any 6 questions Each question carries 5 marks

13. Observe the feasibility of the application of patrimonial state model in pre-modern Chinese society. [An] / [CO2] – Patrimonialism is a form of political organization where authority is based on the direct or indirect personal power exercised by the ruler – Rule alone or as part of an oligarchy – Personal control over the administrative staffs – Support of intellectual and moral elements like priests or philosophers and military – recognition of ruler as the chief landlord or owner of all land – unchallenged legal authority – These features could identify in premodern Chinese polity where Emperor was all powerful, administer with a Grand Secretariat and Bords – moralist and idealist Confucius teachings regarded society as a loose aggregate of family units with ruling family at the head – Traditional customs were employed to establish control over state – Peripheral regions and neighbouring territories were brought under control by employing the idea of Chinese emperor as elder brother of the rulers there.

14. Observe the growth of parliamentary democracy in England. [U] / [CO4] – Movements for Civil Liberties and against oppressive authoritarianism from Magna Carta onwards – Dispute over authority between King and Parliament – culminated in Civil Wars – Victory of Parliament over Kings army – Revolution of 1688 – Bill of Rights – Acknowledgement of parliamentary authority by royalty and creation of constitutional monarchy – Recognition of regular parliaments, free election and freedom of speech in the parliament.

15. Examine the repressive mechanisms evolved in the church during the Counter Reformation. [U] / [CO3] – Inquisition or Holy Office was a human trial mechanism including the torturing of body – those who objected official dogmas branded as heretic and hunted – punishment included confiscation of wealth or handed over to secular authority for death punishment – Censorship of books: an index of prohibited books published – banned and burned books of Protestant reformers and those apostates who rejected church dogmas- Witch hunting: medieval women torturing system – versatile and women of self-pride were branded as witch and burned at stake.

16. Examine the development of Enlightenment in England. [U] / [CO3] – Seventeenth century England noted for political stability and recognition of individual rights – Liberal and rational attitude - Stamina from the political treatise of John Locke – Image of human superiority against nature in literature: works of Jonathan Swift and Daniel Defoe – Appreciation of popular culture in art forms – Philosophical advancement in the works of David Hume and Adam Smith, problematized various branch of knowledge and brought into the scheme of episteme – Advocated the abolition of inhuman practices like slavery – Establishment of centres of liberal thought like coffee houses – Creation of Freemasonry.

17. Examine the changes in the knowledge regarding human anatomy from Galan to Andreas Vesalius. [U] / [CO4] – Undue influence of Galan and the Greek knowledge in medicine till Vesalius – Stigmas on dissection and other medicinal inquiries in Europe prevented the creation of new knowledge – crude comparison of monkey's body to human body – Vesalius proved many Greek notions on anatomy wrong – identified difference between human and ape body – published arguments under the title *De humani corporis fabrica*

18. Analyse the development of modern bourgeoisie in Western Europe. [An] / [CO4] – Class sprung from merchants rank and relied on commercial wealth rather than landed wealth in Europe – Town bred, mercantile and industrious class – Established following the breakup of medieval guild system and gained during free market economy – Became much stronger following commercial revolution and industrial revolution – Emerged as class possessed all means of consumption, new raw materials and instruments necessary for production – Employers of wage labour – Economically dominant class control the state apparatus and cultural production – Instrumental in the creation of liberal outlook and parliamentary system.

19. Observe the major developments in the astronomical knowledge with Johannes Kepler. [U] / [CO4] – Frames the famous three laws of planetary motion in two of his works, namely, *Astronomia Nova* and *De harmonica Monte*, namely, a) planets revolving sun in an elliptical path, b) a line segment joining a planet and the sun sweeps out equal area during equal intervals of time, and c) the square of a planet's orbital period is proportional to the cube of the length of the semi major axis of its orbit – employed mathematical calculations for theoretical understanding

20. Examine the ecological aspects of the European colonialism. [U] / [CO5] – Destruction of the native ecology – Columbian Exchange: American colonization of Europeans marked by the entry of new biological characters in the form of diseases and plants – Small pox and other diseases, once alien to America brought with colonialism led to the perishing of indigenous population – new crops and landscaping for its cultivation changed the vegetation and topographical patterns – Colonialism was ecological too, argument of Alfred Crosby – Plantation industry destroyed the biodiversity.

21. Examine the concept of 'labour creates value' in relation with commodity production. [E] / [CO5] – Commodity is the product of labour – a commodity possessed two values; use value and exchange value – Use value may varies on the basis of use and person, exchange value is determined by the amount of labour embodied in it - The amount of labour is measured through measuring the labouring time. This value is fixed by the social labour that is the socially necessary labour time required to produce a commodity – Labour is the only element in the production process that can add and enhance the value of commodity - Value of a commodity is determined by the total quantity of labour contained in it. Part of the labour contained in the commodity is paid labour and unpaid labour, this unpaid part constituted the profit of the capitalist.

22. Examine the nature European colonization of the North America. [U] / [CO5] – Indigenous community had been either driven off or purged in North America and confiscated their land – English were in the forefront of this – employed puritan Christian logics to legitimize the massacre – Indigenous population looked as someone going to corrupt the Christian world – Instead of proselytization the English Colonial interests primarily on land - French attempts on conversion culminated in the birth of nativized European in French Canada – Colonialist generally given native population with apocryphal traits, branded as not fully rational natural slaves, human sacrificing cannibals, technologically inferior and inherently cowardly people.

Part C - ESSAY QUESTION

Answer any 2 questions, Each question carries 10 marks

23. Examine the influence of Enlightenment on the political philosophy of then Europe. [An] / [CO3] – Enlightenment an intellectual movement celebrated rationality, humanism and critical thinking – new world view in relation to the working of political system – Encountered with the divine right of rulership – John Locke's treatises on government – pointed to the aspect of good governance and welfare of the ruled – Stressed on the importance of good laws, sometimes international law for all – Montesquieu

advocated the separation of powers – Voltaire, a great critique of authoritarian ancient regime –The social contract theory of Rousseau – Idea of Enlightened Despotism – constitutional monarchy.

24. Outline the major innovations during Industrial Revolution with special reference to the development of electrical power [An] / [CO4] – Advancement in production with new source of energy – third phase marked by the thrive provided by electricity during 1800– application of science to the problems of economic production – Humphrey Davy's electrolysis used in the electroplating industry from the 1830s. Michael Faraday's electric motor in 1821 and the dynamo in 1831 - electric telegraph proved a success and further improved with 'needle system' of Samuel Morse, facilitated fast coordination of financial and commodity market – self ignited generators and dynamos facilitated the availability of electric power – Invention of incandescent electric lamp extended the working hours – Machine complex in the factory became automated in nature – larger alienation of worker from produce occurred – extreme labour exploitation in the hazardous locations like mines with the availability of electric light mechanism.

25. Observe the nature and working of the mercantilist system in Europe [U] / [CO5] – mercantilism is an economic nationalism – A system of political economy that sought to enrich the country by restraining imports and encouraging exports to achieve a "favourable" balance of trade that would bring gold and silver into the country and also to maintain domestic employment - Most of the mercantilist policies were the outgrowth of the relationship between the governments of the nation-states and their mercantile classes - government assisted local industry by imposing tariffs, quotas, and prohibitions on imports of goods that competed with local manufacturers – prohibited the export of tools and equipment and emigration of labour – bounty given to ship builders and merchants - In France, Jean-Baptiste Colbert, the minister of finance under Louis XIV from 1661 to 1683, increased port duties on foreign vessels entering French ports and provided bounties to French shipbuilders - In England, the Navigation Act of 1651 prohibited foreign vessels from engaging in coastal trade in England and required that all goods imported from the continent of Europe be carried on either an English vessel or a vessel registered in the country of origin of the goods - The Staple Act of 1663 extended the Navigation Act by requiring that all colonial exports to Europe be landed through an English port before being re-exported to Europe. Navigation policies by France, England, and other powers were directed primarily against the Dutch, who dominated commercial marine activity in the sixteenth and seventeenth centuries.

26. Review the impacts of the French Revolution in the French society [An] / [CO4] – Birth of ideologies; liberalism, nationalism, revolution and republicanism – End of the Bourbon rule in France – Change in the land ownership pattern – Decline in the power of the French Catholic Church – Laying the groundwork for socialism and labour and popular movements – Destruction of oligarchies – Emergence of metric system – Rise of Napoleon and Napoleonic Wars.